Build the foundation

Personal construction / Use Play for resolution and Run for creatures and advancement.

Build the foundation

1. Agree concept, setting, starting level/budget and separate equipment terms. Default level 1 has **25 character BU**. BU means Build Units, the acquisition budget.
2. Allocate base **Physical, Mental, Magical**: total **10**, each from **-1 to +5**. Apply acquired modifications separately; use current values directly as bonuses.
3. Choose the **proficient attribute**. Its practices and save receive PB. Record any additional actual training; repeating a grant does not repeatedly add PB.
4. Acquire positive owned **Verb and Domain** access in the character build. Equipment or mirrored access alone does not satisfy this foundation. Missing Range/Output categories use **Touch and 1d4** baselines.
5. Buy or author useful ingredients. Organize them into effects, capabilities or heritage if useful. Count the same owned acquisition once, regardless of references.
6. Record equipment separately. Resolve the current sheet and starting state. Review normal, stretched and outside-scope uses with the table.

Attributes and practices

Attribute	Practices
Physical	Prowess; Finesse; Fieldcraft.
Mental	Awareness; Reason; Knowledge; Influence.
Magical	Mysticism; Communion; Intuition.

Practice bonus = full current parent attribute + applicable training + actual qualifying modifiers. Ordinary attempts need no training. Proficiency training adds **one PB**; eligible expertise adds **twice PB**. An explicit numerical bonus has its own scope.

Save bonus = relevant current attribute + actual save training + qualifying modifiers. Choosing a proficient attribute trains its save; acquiring one practice's proficiency does not train that save.

Resolve the sheet

PB = 2 + floor((level - 1) / 4), then active PB rules. Floor takes the lower whole number.

DC = 5 + current PB + a selected eligible proficient attribute (current value) + direct DC contributions. This one DC is distinct from your three save bonuses.

Maximum Vitality = (10 + current PB) x level, then actual maximum-Vitality rules. Increasing maximum alone does not heal current Vitality. Ordinary short-rest allowance is half maximum rounded up between completed long rests.

Body, movement and carrying

Size	Walk	Base capacity	Item Load
Tiny	15 ft	10	Pouch
Small	25 ft	20	1
Medium	30 ft	40	2
Large	40 ft	80	4
Huge	60 ft	160	8
Gargantuan	90 ft	320	16

Ordinary swim/climb is half walking Speed rounded up. Flight and burrowing need permission. The movement allowance spans the whole round, including reactions.

Use body size for movement/capacity and each item's size for its Load. **Capacity** = size base + 5 x current Physical + actual bonuses. Above capacity, agree encumbrance penalties. One pouch holds up to 1,000 Tiny objects for **1 Load**. Authored Load rules can change a contribution.

Equipment has separate accounting

Item BU measures an item's mechanics. Ordinary value/currency describes setting price and availability. **Load** measures carried burden. **Slots** measure equipped use. These are four different records.

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Bound your permissions

Personal construction / Use Play for resolution and Run for creatures and advancement.

CONTINUED / EQUIPMENT HAS SEPARATE ACCOUNTING

You have **six universal equipped slots**, plus actual grants. Ordinary equipped gear uses one; two-handed gear uses two. Unusual gear can have a greater authored requirement. Size alone does not multiply final slot cost.

Carried items contribute Load even when not equipped. Equipped items still contribute Load. A backpack organizes contents; it does not automatically increase capacity. Count actual quantities and state when an item's rules apply: carried, equipped or actively used.

Ordinary example: one Medium two-handed canal hook has Item BU 0, Load 2 and two final equipped slots. A carried spare adds Load but no equipped slots. Its length gives no extraordinary Near permission.

Establish current state

Record current/maximum Vitality, remaining short-rest allowance, location, ongoing consequences and maintained workings. During an encounter also track Main Intent, movement used and remaining Reaction Slot.

Character progression uses cumulative BU thresholds in **Run**. Spending acquisition BU does not reduce established level. A character can author or acquire new ingredients during play by agreement. Keep real state when reorganizing the sheet; editing a maximum or heritage does not erase wounds or consequences.

Access tiers / separate purchases

Verb is what changes; **Domain** is its bound subject; **Structure** is its arrangement. A tier is family-specific. Water I grants grounded Water, not all Tier I domains. A tier number grants no omniscience or automatic success.

CONTINUED / ACCESS TIERS / SEPARATE PURCHASES

Tier / BU	Bound access meaning
I / 4	**Verb:** direct physical/perceptual interaction, simple creation/destruction/force within scope. **Domain:** observable grounded subjects such as water or stone. **Structure:** self, touch, one point or target.
II / 8	**Verb:** reshape, redirect, combine, separate, transfer or stabilize existing states/properties. **Domain:** physical/conceptual systems such as life, memory, emotion or bounded local space/time. **Structure:** small groups, lines, cones, radii or fields.
III / 12	**Verb:** reconfigure internal systems, impose constraints or redirect bounded causal chains. **Domain:** abstract/systemic subjects such as identity, information or bounded causality. **Structure:** moving zones, branching chains or conditional/adaptive patterns.
IV / 16	**Verb:** alter governing logic or fundamental constraints within agreed scope. **Domain:** existence, reality, global causality or foundational laws. **Structure:** scene-wide rules, priority or state-driven inclusion/exclusion.

Read the actual bound definition when an idea overlaps tiers. Higher permission can support narrower eligible use; it does not create another acquired occurrence of every lower-labelled entry.

Write the rule before its price

Record **name; readable rule; recipient/target; operation or permission; value/subject; conditions; stacking/uniqueness; ending; proposed BU; source/version**. Descriptive rules are valid. Numeric fields help only where the rule is genuinely numerical.

Example: "While both hands are free, add +2 to your Finesse checks to thread or tie a rope." State self as recipient and Add as operation. Proposing **4 BU** is an authored example for review, not a new universal +2 tariff.

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The primitive language

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Reach and output anchors

Range	Bound reach	BU
Touch	Self/contact/appropriate ordinary melee.	0
Near	Up to 30 ft.	4
Far	Up to 60 ft.	8
Very Far	Up to 120 ft.	12
Extreme	Continuous reach up to about 3 miles; extensions by agreement.	24

Eligible die type	d4	d6	d8	d10	d12	d20
Suggested BU	0	2	4	8	16	32

Range supplies reach, not target knowledge or direct manifestation. Output supplies a die type for suitable damage/healing behavior, not an attack, healing permission, number of dice or recipients. Missing categories use Touch and 1d4.

Core grant anchors

Proposed acquisition	Suggested BU
+1 chosen attribute, with its actual agreed limits.	12
Proficiency in one named practice.	4
PB training for a specified save.	4

Other families have no universal four-tier price ladder. State and price the actual permission. Scaling dice count, recipients, area or duration within access may increase contextual pressure without each requiring a new purchase; additional behavior still requires access.

Make each operation intelligible

Add/Subtract: change a named value by an amount. **Multiply/Divide:** apply a factor/divisor to that value. **Minimum/Maximum:** establish its lower/upper bound. **Set To:** establish the specified value. **Grant/Revoke:** supply/remove the specified permission or training. Respect each rule's actual scope, conditions and stage.

A check-result minimum is not a minimum parent attribute. A permission grant is not automatically a static +1. Apply qualifying contributions and stacking restrictions; repeated training does not add PB repeatedly.

Ordinary rounding is upward, except an explicitly specified operation such as floor in PB. Keep intermediate precision until the stated rounding step. Do not round a creature's square-root rank before using it.

Access and expression / families 1-9

Verb; Domain; Structure. State the change, bound subject and arrangement. The tier meanings and acquisition anchors appear under Access tiers.

Range Scaling. State reach and any boundary/targeting condition; locate the target separately.

Speed and Quickening. State which execution becomes faster and when. A real dependency still has to happen first.

Duration and Persistence. State instant, fixed duration, event ending or continuation requirements. Duration grants no automatic immunity to interference.

Semantic State Tags. Define who qualifies, the actual change and its ending. "Invisible," "frozen" or "blessed" is not a complete imported rules package.

Targeting Arrays and Dimensional Sizing. Define shape, inclusion/exclusion, recipients and limits. Area is not automatic ally safety.

Intensity and Damage Dice. Specify eligible dice/intensity plus actual damage/healing behavior and source/domain. Dice count is scale, not unrelated behavior.

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From rule families to a character

Personal construction / Use Play for resolution and Run for creatures and advancement.

Character foundation / families 10-17

Vitality Extension. State the maximum or other Vitality rule changed. Maximum and current Vitality remain separate.

Practice and Character Core Progression. Specify attribute, training, expertise, PB or related contribution. Use full current parent attributes and actual training.

Universal Mathematical Modifiers. Name the quantity, operation, amount/factor and conditions. Attribute, check, attack and save are different scopes.

Advantage and Probability Bias. Specify the roll, conditions and stacking. Default N net stacks use N + 1 dice, highest/lowest; static bonus is separate.

Perception and Detection Qualifiers. Define what can be noticed or distinguished. Detecting magic does not automatically identify its maker.

Sensory Arrays and Informational Horizons. Define channel, reach, obstacles, location information and limits. A sense grants only its stated information.

Spatial Mobility and Kinematic Locomotion. State mode and speed. Flight permission and flying Speed both need definition.

Structural Defenses and Passive Mitigations. Name covered source, domain, condition or combination. Resistance halves matching damage rounded up; vulnerability doubles; immunity covers only its actual scope.

System and reality / families 18-25

Runtime Trigger Hooks. Define event, eligible observer/recipient, response and limits. A trigger alone gives no extra action or Reaction Slot.

Kinetic and Spatial Control. Specify force, motion or position, route and opposition. Restraint, redirection and teleportation are distinct behaviors.

Agency and Information Overrides. Define the intrusion, recipients, resolution and ending. Agree boundaries with the people playing. A suggestion is not unrestricted control or knowledge.

CONTINUED / SYSTEM AND REALITY / FAMILIES 18-25

Structural Metamorphosis. State what changes, what persists and how it ends. A cosmetic form grants no unstated attacks, equipment or defenses.

Action Economy Alterations. State the extra intent, reaction or timing opportunity and limits. Size and titles grant none automatically.

Capability Evaluation, Resource Strain, and Dial Management. Define the resource/evaluation, spending, refresh and relation to a working. Acquisition BU and execution Cost stay distinct.

Temporal Ordering, Durations, and Stasis. Specify affected actions/effects, interval, ending and interaction with Council/tracks. “Another turn” alone is insufficient.

Boss Action Economy and Encounter Rhythms. Author any extra opportunities and make their timing legible. “Boss” itself grants nothing; the shared rhythm remains unless explicitly varied.

Additional tools / families 26-29

Size Tier and Scale. Define size and actual scaling. Size changes movement/capacity baselines, not automatically final slots or damage dice.

Sheet Augment. Name the sheet field, operation, limit and scope. Extra slots are not extra carrying capacity or Item BU.

Heritage Augment. Define the changed heritage ingredient or limitation. Lineage, Upbringing and Manifest are narrative containers, not fixed class progression.

Item Augment. Define the item permission/change and whether carried, equipped or active. Preserve separate Item BU, Load and slot accounting.

Organize without inventing mechanics

An **Effect** groups related ingredients/outcomes. A **Capability** organizes a working/talent and may reference effects or primitives directly. No compulsory nesting chain exists. Record normal use/trigger, actual changes, targets, limits and continuation.

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Ownership, mirrors and review

Personal construction / Use Play for resolution and Run for creatures and advancement.

CONTINUED / ORGANIZE WITHOUT INVENTING MECHANICS

Lineage, Upbringing and Manifest describe ancestry, experience and present expression. Choose what helps your story; there is no compulsory one-of-each package. Descriptive history need not grant mechanics. A container changes no budget or permissions by its name alone.

Mira / a complete starting character

Concept: a canal-boat repairer wants to reopen an abandoned trade route. **Foundation:** level 1, 25 character BU, Medium. Physical 3, Mental 3, Magical 4 total 10. Magical is proficient; PB 2.

Positive acquisition	BU
Verb II: reshape/redirect/transfer eligible existing states.	8
Water I: grounded water, not all physical subjects.	4
Near: eligible reach to 30 ft with actual targeting/path.	4
d8: eligible output die type, not extra behavior.	4
Knowledge proficiency: add PB where eligible.	4
Total / unspent from 25	24 / 1

Resolved sheet: Physical practices +3; Awareness/Reason/Influence +3; Knowledge +5; Magical practices +6. Saves +3 Physical, +3 Mental, +6 Magical. Magical-selected DC = 5 + 2 + 4 = 11. Maximum/current Vitality 12/12; short-rest allowance 6. Walk 30 ft; swim/climb 15 ft. Capacity **55 Load**, six slots.

Equipment: one ordinary Medium two-handed hook, Item BU 0, Load 2, two equipped slots. No automatic extraordinary range or numerical bonus.

River Caravan Upbringing organizes Verb II, Water I and Knowledge: 16 BU already included above. **Guided Water**, an effect, references Verb II, Water I and Near. **River Hand**, a capability, uses it to redirect existing located water within 30 ft. Appraise volume, path, opposition, timing and continuation. The d8 can support a separately defined suitable water impact; this description grants no healing.

Count ownership, not appearances

Reference Mira's Water I in a second capability and her ledger stays **24/25**. A deliberately acquired additional occurrence is different and follows its actual price, stacking and uniqueness rules. Count real item quantities separately. Adopt readable source versions; a future edit must not silently rewrite an existing character's wounds or rules.

Mirrors and real drawbacks

Eligible opposites include **Add/Subtract; Multiply/Divide; Minimum/Maximum; Grant/Revoke**. Set To has no automatic opposite. Respect non-mirrorable limits and actual access. Descriptive reversals need a coherent agreed meaning.

An accepted personal drawback stays applied to its recipient and ledger. Separately proposing the opposite for an ally does not suppress the drawback or repay it. Merely arranging the same drawback in another heritage grants no extra credit.

Default debt ceiling = **4 x ceil(level / 4)**: 4 for levels 1–4, 8 for 5–8, 12 for 9–12, continuing. The ceiling is not free BU. Record ordinary budget, positive spending, accepted credit, used debt, unused credit and uncovered excess distinctly.

Example A: budget 25, positive spent 23, credit 0: ordinary unspent 2, debt 0.

Example B: budget 25, positive spent 27, accepted credit 2: base used 25, used debt 2, uncovered excess 0. The drawback remains real. DM agreement is required to exceed ordinary allowance; the four-point credit ceiling and next-level creation reference of 35 still apply.

Example C: positive spent 31 with only 2 credit: base used 25, covered debt 2, uncovered excess 4. The ceiling invents no additional credit. This needs explicit approval for its uncovered excess and remains subject to current creation limits.

Take the creation into play

Test a qualifying use, a demanding eligible use and an outside-scope idea with the table. Use **Play** for resolution/recovery and **Run** for creatures, encounters and progression. **Create & Publish** covers distribution, selling and attribution.

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